were, after all, rather minor compared to some. Pascual Jordan maintained that he had never truly supported the Nazi cause, despite his publications extolling the virtues of a National Socialist approach to science. He even had the audacity to send a letter to Max Born, his mentor who had been forced out by Hitler's racist policies, explaining that he hadn't really been a Nazi and asking for a character reference for his "de-Nazification." Born replied with a list of his friends and family members murdered by the Nazis.) Given the damage done to his reputation by his activities during the war, Heisenberg's invention of a single unified Copenhagen interpretation may have been an attempt to rework the history of quantum physics to his benefit. The Copenhagen interpretation wasn't a pure fabrication—there were certainly similarities in the positions that Bohr and his students and colleagues took—but the differences between Heisenberg's lecture and the writings of Bohr himself should have been enough to tip off anyone who was paying attention that no such beast had ever really existed.

Yet the idea of a single settled interpretation of quantum physics, associated with the giants Bohr and Heisenberg, went over well in the post-Manhattan world of Big Science. Most physicists were perfectly happy with the jumble of ideas that purportedly constituted the Copenhagen interpretation itself, since questions about the meaning of quantum physics had little bearing on their work. The mathematical formalism of the theory continued to work remarkably well in a wide variety of postwar applications of physics to the military-industrial complex, which turned most physicists to work in nuclear physics or solid-state physics (the branch of physics that, shortly after the war, led to the development of the silicon transistor, as well as many of the other materials later responsible for the shrinking size and ballooning importance of computers). Questions of interpretation, while vital for the progress of science in the long term, were immaterial when it came to the hard-nosed applications of quantum theory that were so suddenly and desperately prized. The Copenhagen interpretation's promise of a complete yet obscure answer to the quantum mysteries allowed the new army of postwar physicists to calculate answers without worrying about the meaning of the theory. The shift of physicists to the United States aided in this as well—in contrast to the great theorists of Europe, physicists in the States had always had an experimental and pragmatic bent. The questions at the foundations of quantum physics that